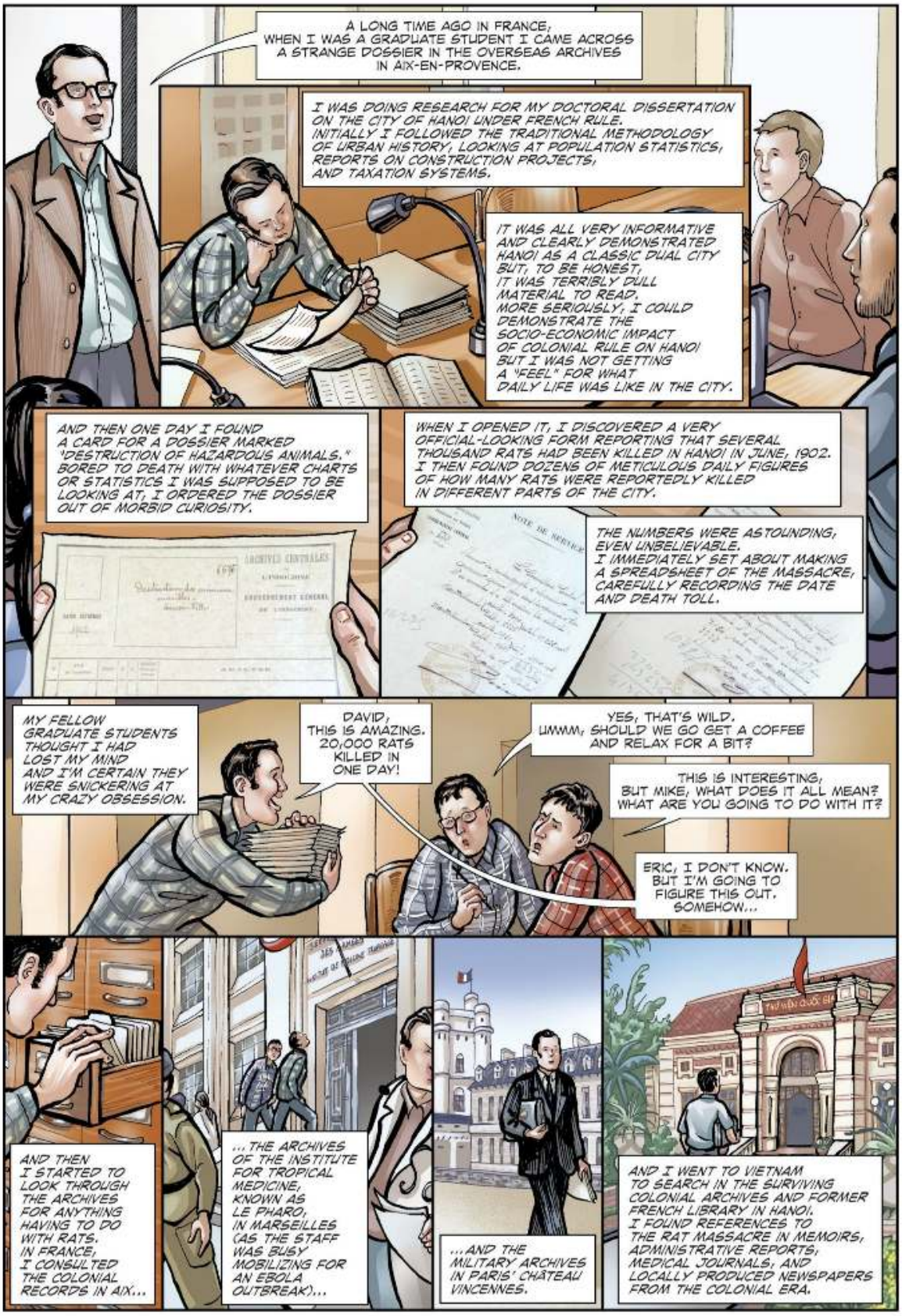
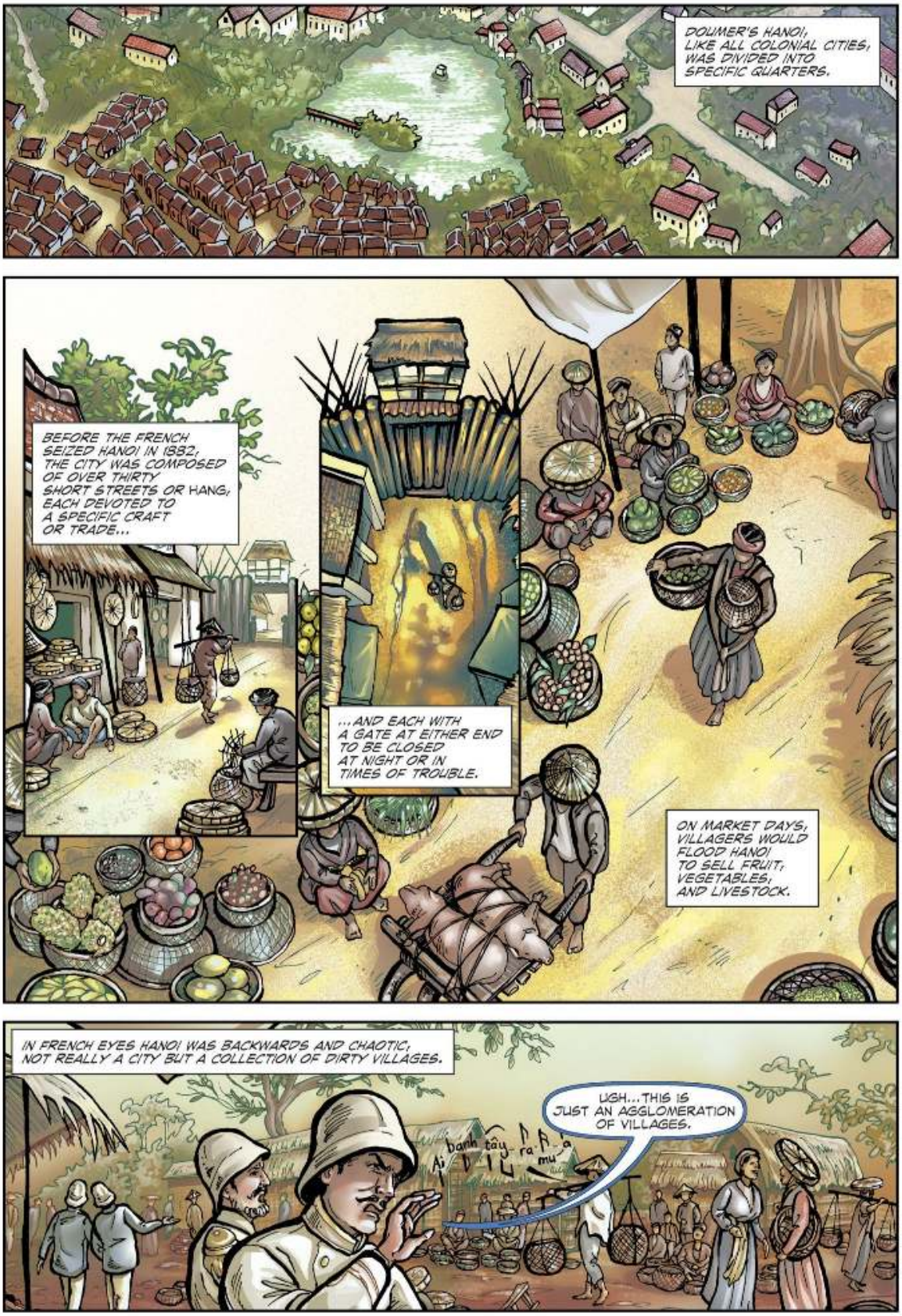
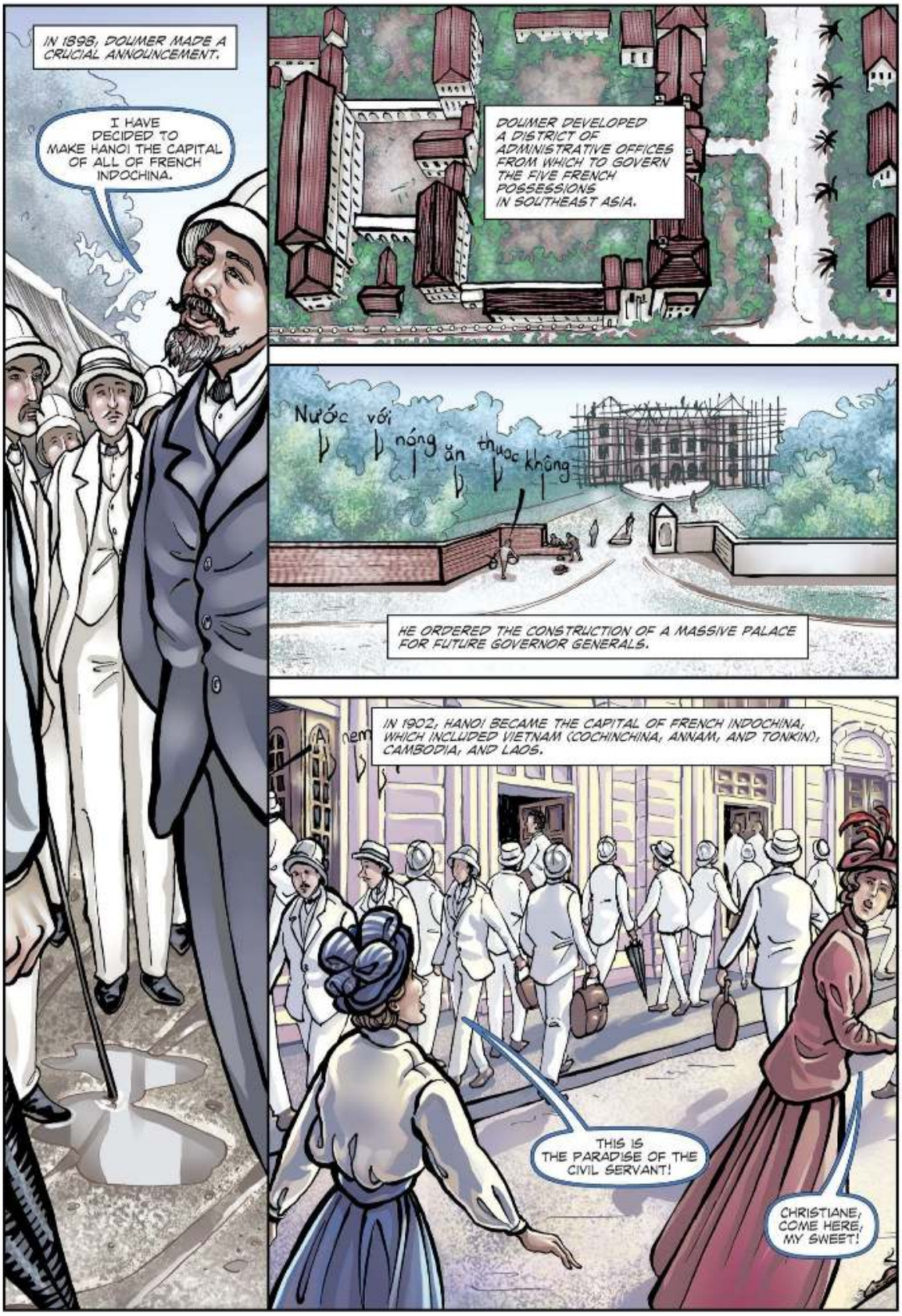
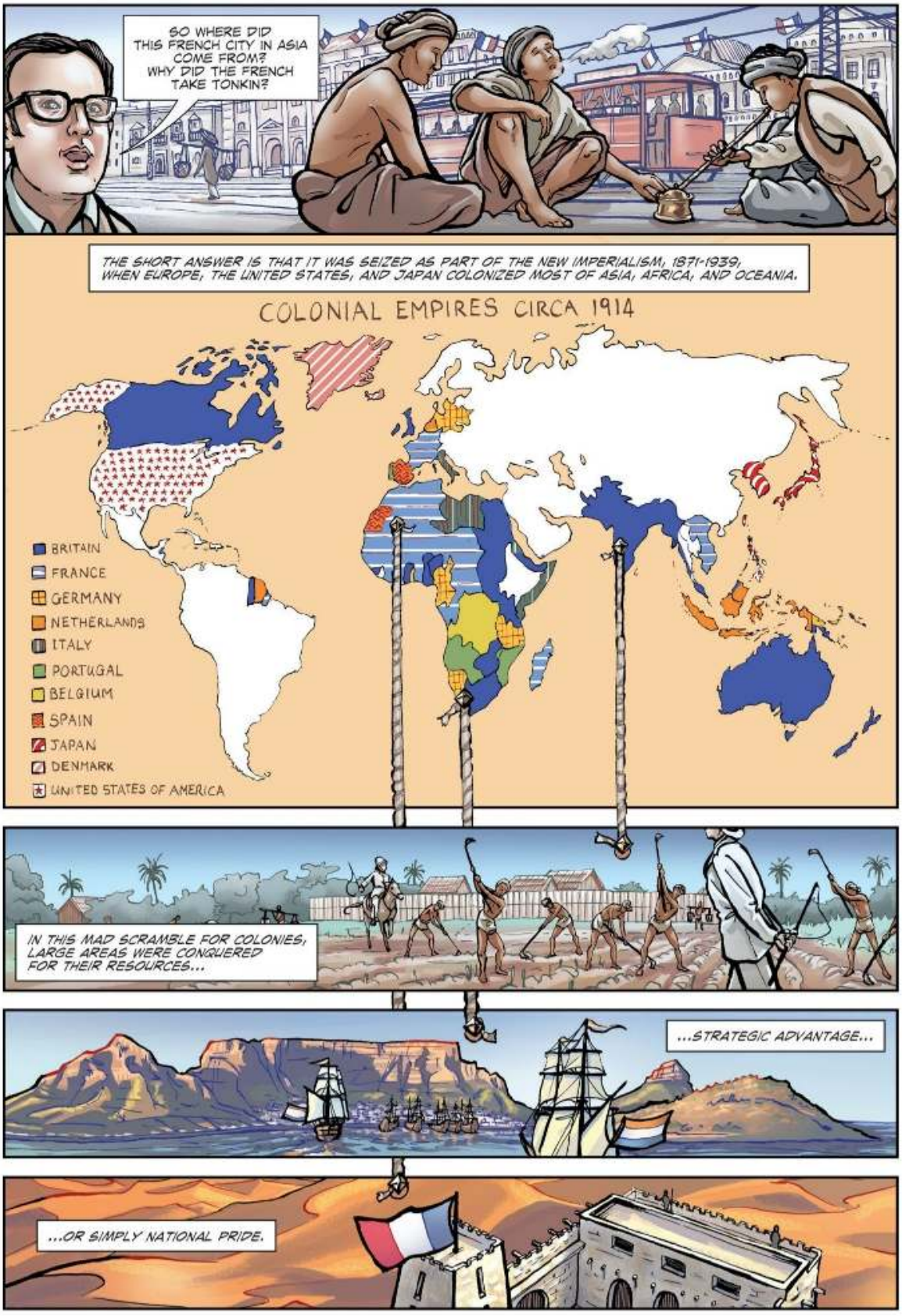

A LONG TIME AGO IN FRANCE, WHEN I WAS A GRADUATE STUDENT I CAME ACROSS A STRANGE DOSSIER IN THE OVERSEAS ARCHIVES IN AIX-EN-PROVENCE.
I WAS DOING RESEARCH FOR MY DOCTORAL DISSERTATION ON THE CITY OF HANOI UNDER FRENCH RULE. INITIALLY I FOLLOWED THE TRADITIONAL METHODOLOGY OF URBAN HISTORY, LOOKING AT POPULATION STATISTICS, REPORTS ON CONSTRUCTION PROJECTS, AND TAXATION SYSTEMS.
IT WAS ALL VERY INFORMATIVE AND CLEARLY DEMONSTRATED HANOI AS A CLASSIC DUAL CITY BUT, TO BE HONEST, IT WAS TERRIBLY DULL MATERIAL TO READ. MORE SERIOUSLY, I COULD DEMONSTRATE THE SOCIO-ECONOMIC IMPACT OF COLONIAL RULE ON HANOI BUT I WAS NOT GETTING A "FEEL" FOR WHAT DAILY LIFE WAS LIKE IN THE CITY.
AND THEN ONE DAY I FOUND A CARD FOR A DOSSIER MARKED "DESTRUCTION OF HAZARDOUS ANIMALS." BORED TO DEATH WITH WHATEVER CHARTS OR STATISTICS I WAS SUPPOSED TO BE LOOKING AT, I ORDERED THE DOSSIER OUT OF MORBID CURIOSITY.
WHEN I OPENED IT, I DISCOVERED A VERY OFFICIAL-LOOKING FORM REPORTING THAT SEVERAL THOUSAND RATS HAD BEEN KILLED IN HANOI IN JUNE, 1902. I THEN FOUND DOZENS OF METICULOUS DAILY FIGURES OF HOW MANY RATS WERE REPORTEDLY KILLED IN DIFFERENT PARTS OF THE CITY.
THE NUMBERS WERE ASTOUNDING, EVEN UNBELIEVABLE. I IMMEDIATELY SET ABOUT MAKING A SPREADSHEET OF THE MASSACRE, CAREFULLY RECORDING THE DATE AND DEATH TOLL.
MY FELLOW GRADUATE STUDENTS THOUGHT I HAD LOST MY MIND AND I'M CERTAIN THEY WERE SNICKERING AT MY CRAZY OBSESSION.
DAVID, THIS IS AMAZING. 20,000 RATS KILLED IN ONE DAY!
YES, THAT'S WILD. UMMM, SHOULD WE GO GET A COFFEE AND RELAX FOR A BIT?
THIS IS INTERESTING, BUT MIKE, WHAT DOES IT ALL MEAN? WHAT ARE YOU GOING TO DO WITH IT?
ERIC, I DON'T KNOW. BUT I'M GOING TO FIGURE THIS OUT. SOMEHOW...
AND THEN I STARTED TO LOOK THROUGH THE ARCHIVES FOR ANYTHING HAVING TO DO WITH RATS. IN FRANCE, I CONSULTED THE COLONIAL RECORDS IN AIX...
...THE ARCHIVES OF THE INSTITUTE FOR TROPICAL MEDICINE, KNOWN AS LE PHARO, IN MARSEILLES (AS THE STAFF WAS BUSY MOBILIZING FOR AN EBOLA OUTBREAK)...
...AND THE MILITARY ARCHIVES IN PARIS' CHÂTEAU VINCENNES.
AND I WENT TO VIETNAM TO SEARCH IN THE SURVIVING COLONIAL ARCHIVES AND FORMER FRENCH LIBRARY IN HANOI. I FOUND REFERENCES TO THE RAT MASSACRE IN MEMOIRS, ADMINISTRATIVE REPORTS, MEDICAL JOURNALS, AND LOCALLY PRODUCED NEWSPAPERS FROM THE COLONIAL ERA.


DOUMER'S HANOI, LIKE ALL COLONIAL CITIES, WAS DIVIDED INTO SPECIFIC QUARTERS.
BEFORE THE FRENCH SEIZED HANOI IN 1882, THE CITY WAS COMPOSED OF OVER THIRTY SHORT STREETS OR HANG, EACH DEVOTED TO A SPECIFIC CRAFT OR TRADE...
...AND EACH WITH A GATE AT EITHER END TO BE CLOSED AT NIGHT OR IN TIMES OF TROUBLE.
ON MARKET DAYS, VILLAGERS WOULD FLOOD HANOI TO SELL FRUIT, VEGETABLES, AND LIVESTOCK.
IN FRENCH EYES HANOI WAS BACKWARDS AND CHAOTIC, NOT REALLY A CITY BUT A COLLECTION OF DIRTY VILLAGES.
UGH... THIS IS JUST AN AGGLOMERATION OF VILLAGES.
banh tây

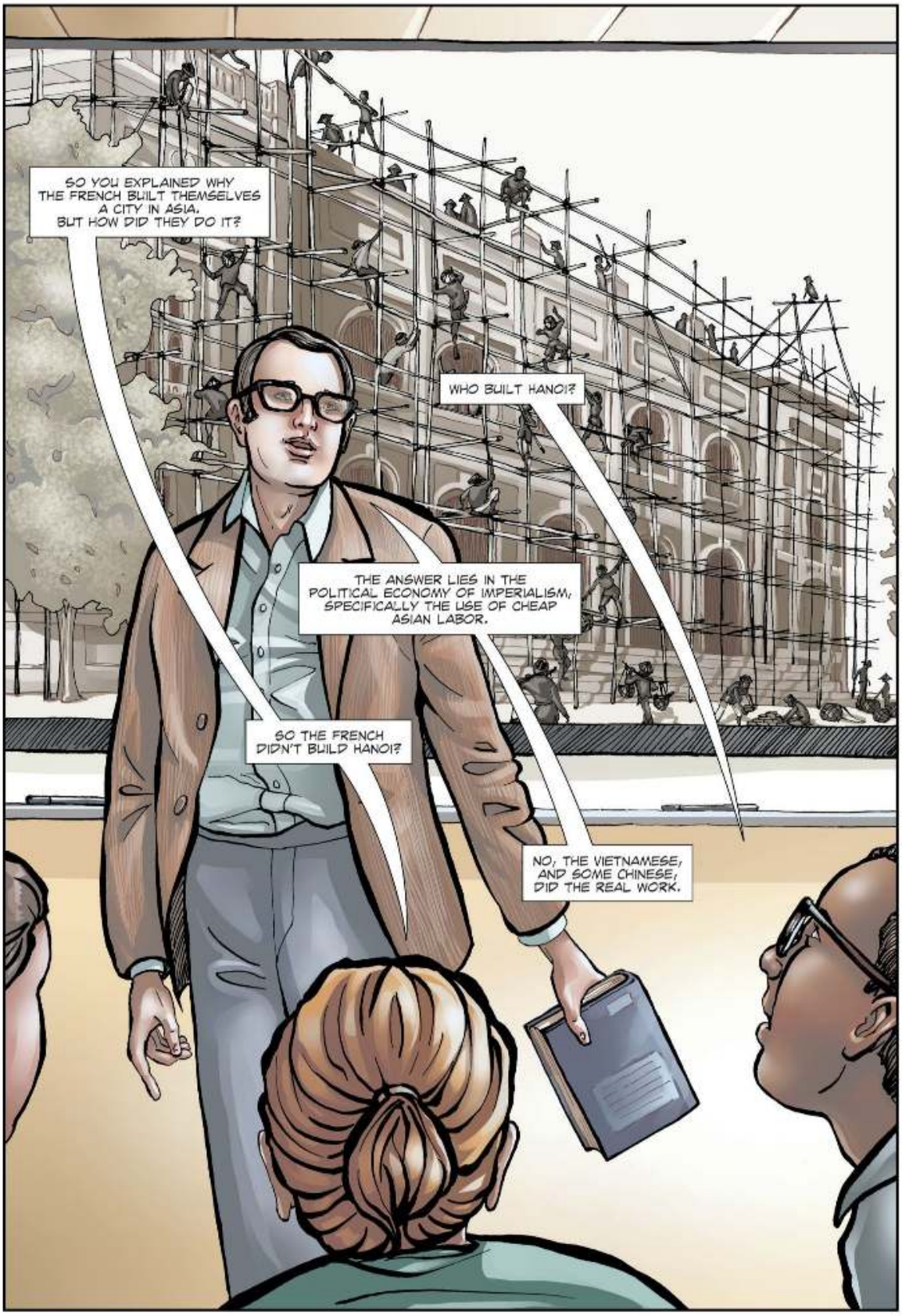

IN 1898, DOUMER MADE A CRUCIAL ANNOUNCEMENT.
I HAVE DECIDED TO MAKE HANOI THE CAPITAL OF ALL OF FRENCH INDOCHINA.
DOUMER DEVELOPED A DISTRICT OF ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICES FROM WHICH TO GOVERN THE FIVE FRENCH POSSESSIONS IN SOUTHEAST ASIA.
Nước với nóng ăn thuoc không
HE ORDERED THE CONSTRUCTION OF A MASSIVE PALACE FOR FUTURE GOVERNOR GENERALS.
IN 1902, HANOI BECAME THE CAPITAL OF FRENCH INDOCHINA, WHICH INCLUDED VIETNAM (COCHINCHINA, ANNAM, AND TONKIN), CAMBODIA, AND LAOS.
THIS IS THE PARADISE OF THE CIVIL SERVANT!
CHRISTIANE, COME HERE, MY SWEET!


SO WHERE DID THIS FRENCH CITY IN ASIA COME FROM? WHY DID THE FRENCH TAKE TONKIN?
THE SHORT ANSWER IS THAT IT WAS SEIZED AS PART OF THE NEW IMPERIALISM, 1871-1939, WHEN EUROPE, THE UNITED STATES, AND JAPAN COLONIZED MOST OF ASIA, AFRICA, AND OCEANIA.
COLONIAL EMPIRES CIRCA 1914
BRITAIN
FRANCE
GERMANY
NETHERLANDS
ITALY
PORTUGAL
BELGIUM
SPAIN
JAPAN
DENMARK
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
IN THIS MAD SCRAMBLE FOR COLONIES, LARGE AREAS WERE CONQUERED FOR THEIR RESOURCES...
...STRATEGIC ADVANTAGE...
...OR SIMPLY NATIONAL PRIDE.

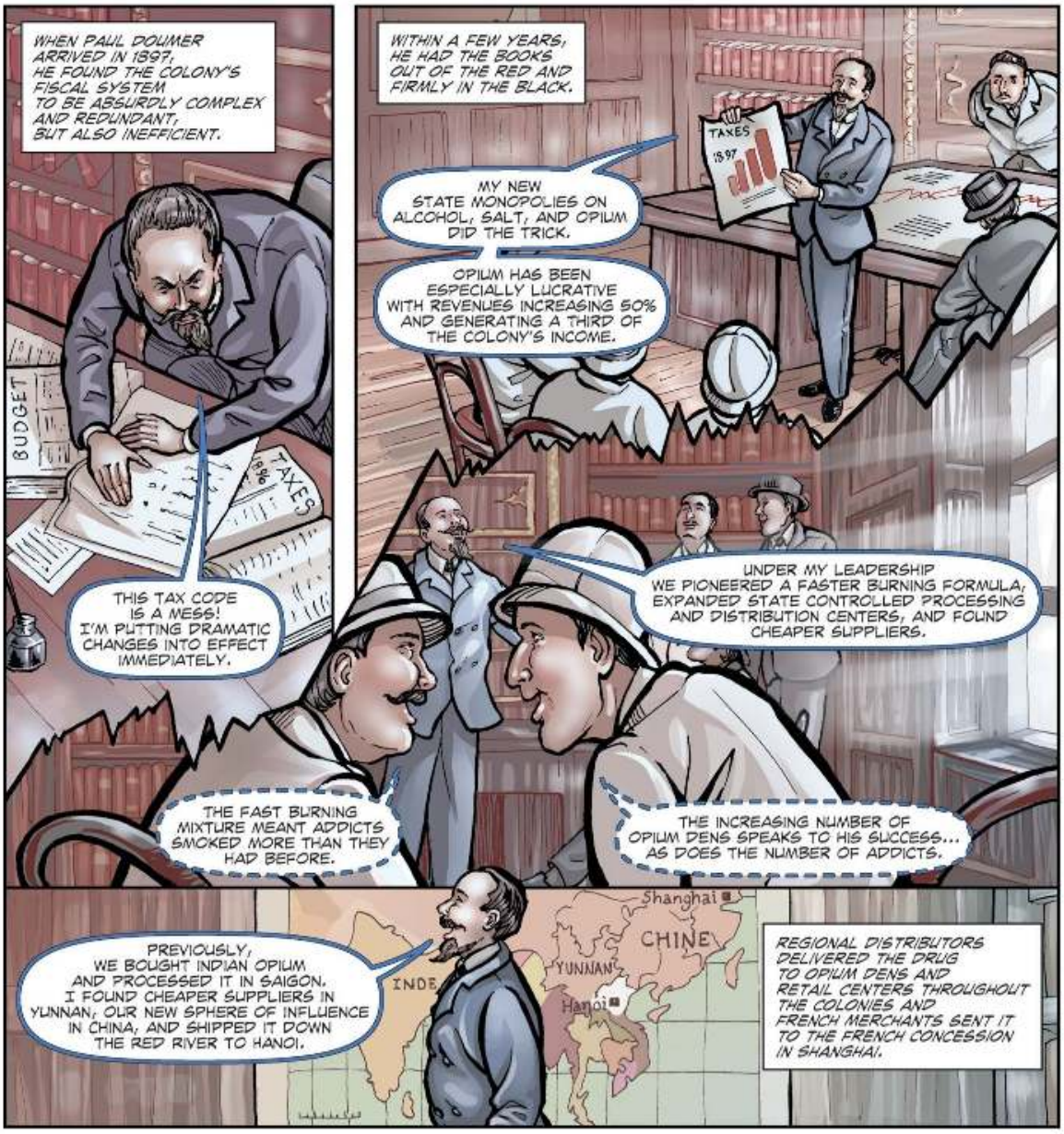

WHEN THE QING DYNASTY OUTLAWED THE OPIUM TRADE, CRACKED DOWN ON FOREIGN NARCO-TRAFFICKERS, AND DESTROYED THOUSANDS OF CRATES OF THE DRUG, THE BRITISH WENT TO WAR, JUSTIFYING IT AS A WAR FOR "FREE TRADE."
I APOLOGIZE TO THE SEA FOR DUMPING THIS POISON INTO YOU.
SENDING THE NEWLY BUILT STEAMSHIP THE NEMESIS, THE BRITISH DEMONSTRATED THAT THE INDUSTRIALIZATION OF WARFARE COULD PROJECT POWER ACROSS THE GLOBE. THE ROYAL NAVY DESTROYED THE QING FLEET AND SHELLED CITIES ALONG THE RIVERS OF SOUTHERN CHINA.


THE TREATY OF NANKING ENDED THE OPIUM WAR, 1839-1842, AND OPENED CHINA TO WESTERN IMPERIALISM.
THE FIRST OF A SERIES OF UNEQUAL TREATIES, IT GAVE BRITAIN CONTROL OF HONG KONG, ESTABLISHED TREATY PORTS SUCH AS SHANGHAI, AND IMPOSED A SYSTEM OF EXTRA-TERRITORIALITY, EXEMPTING FOREIGNERS FROM CHINESE LAW.
WHILE NOT FORMALLY COLONIZED, CHINA ENTERED ITS "CENTURY OF HUMILIATIONS."

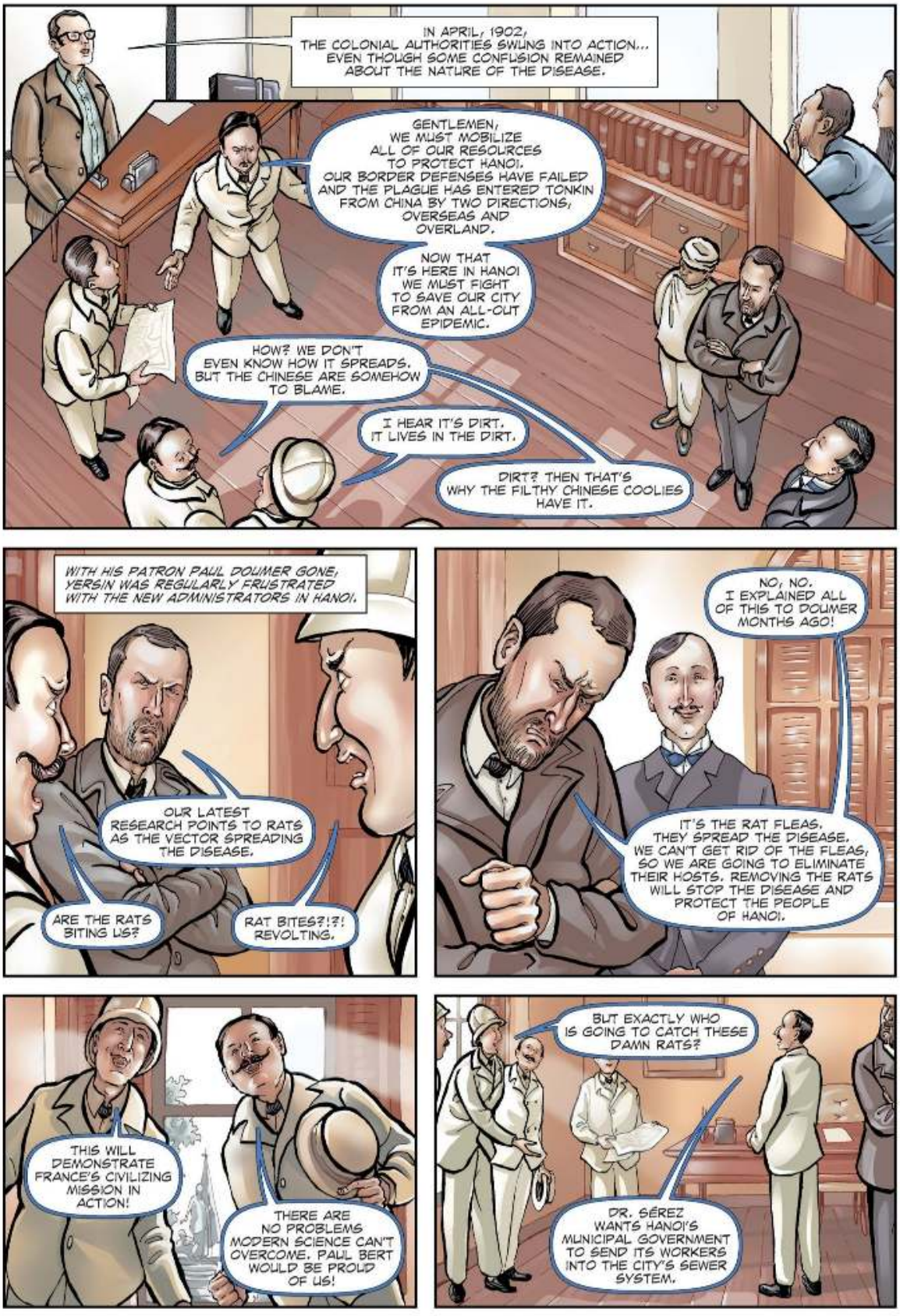

CAPTAIN FRANCIS GARNIER TOOK CHARGE OF THE SURVIVING EXPEDITION MEMBERS.
HALF THE MEN ARE DEAD. THE MEKONG IS TOO DANGEROUS FOR COMMERCE OR OUR RETURN TO CAMBODIA.
WE ARE GOING TO COLLECT WHAT SCIENTIFIC INFORMATION WE CAN AND HEAD EAST TO THE FRENCH CONCESSION IN SHANGHAI.
CHINE
Shanghai
YUNNAN
Hanoi
IN YUNNAN GARNIER MET A CURIOUS FIGURE: JEAN DUPUIS, A FRENCHMAN IN CHINESE DRESS NEGOTIATING AN ARMS DEAL WITH THE MUSLIM REBELS.
THE TWO SOON BEGAN TO CONSPIRE.
SO THIS RIVER FLOWS TO TONKIN?
YES, THE RED RIVER FLOWS TO THE SOUTH BUT VIETNAM IS CLOSED TO FOREIGN TRADE.
BUT IF I WERE TO ENTER TONKIN AND GET INTO TROUBLE, WOULD YOU BE ABLE TO HELP ME OUT?
HMMMM...
HAILED AS A HERO UPON HIS RETURN TO EUROPE, GARNIER PROMOTED FRENCH EXPANSION IN TONKIN.
YES, YES... I WAS MAD FOR THE MEKONG BUT NOW WE SHOULD THINK ABOUT THE RED RIVER.
ROYAL GEOGRAPHIC SOC
IN 1873, DUPUIS TRIED TO SMUGGLE GUNS THROUGH TONKIN AND CAME INTO CONFLICT WITH LOCAL OFFICIALS.
CHINE
Red
TONKIN
River
Hanoi
Mekong
WITHOUT AUTHORIZATION FROM PARIS, GARNIER INVADED NORTHERN VIETNAM AND SEIZED SEVERAL CITIES INCLUDING HANOI.
BEFORE HE COULD CONSOLIDATE HIS CONQUESTS, CHINESE PIRATES KNOWN AS THE BLACK FLAGS KILLED AND DECAPITATED HIM JUST OUTSIDE OF HANOI.
PARIS ORDERED FRENCH FORCES OUT OF TONKIN.


SO YOU EXPLAINED WHY THE FRENCH BUILT THEMSELVES A CITY IN ASIA. BUT HOW DID THEY DO IT?
WHO BUILT HANOI?
THE ANSWER LIES IN THE POLITICAL ECONOMY OF IMPERIALISM, SPECIFICALLY THE USE OF CHEAP ASIAN LABOR.
SO THE FRENCH DIDN'T BUILD HANOI?
NO, THE VIETNAMESE, AND SOME CHINESE, DID THE REAL WORK.


CHINA
HAWAII
CALIFORNIA
INDIA
MALAYA
REUNION
AUSTRALIA
FIJI
WITH POOR WAGES, LACK OF BASIC FREEDOMS AND PROTECTIONS, AND RACIALIZED IDENTITY OF THE WORKERS, THE INDIAN AND CHINESE COOLIE SYSTEM WAS A SECOND SLAVERY. LIKE THE AFRICAN SLAVE TRADE, THE COOLIE TRADE RESULTED IN A GLOBAL DIASPORA OF SOUTH ASIANS AND CHINESE.
THOUSANDS OF DESPERATE CHINESE SOUGHT A BETTER LIFE MUCH CLOSER TO HOME IN TONKIN.
IN HANOI AND HAIPHONG, NETWORKS OF SUCCESSFUL CHINESE ENTREPRENEURS ORGANIZED AND PROFITED FROM THE COOLIE TRADE, SUPPLYING THE FRENCH WITH ARMIES OF LOW WAGE AND UNSKILLED LABORERS.


WHEN PAUL DOUMER ARRIVED IN 1897, HE FOUND THE COLONY'S FISCAL SYSTEM TO BE ABSURDLY COMPLEX AND REDUNDANT, BUT ALSO INEFFICIENT.
BUDGET
TAXES
THIS TAX CODE IS A MESS! I'M PUTTING DRAMATIC CHANGES INTO EFFECT IMMEDIATELY.
WITHIN A FEW YEARS, HE HAD THE BOOKS OUT OF THE RED AND FIRMLY IN THE BLACK.
TAXES
1897
MY NEW STATE MONOPOLIES ON ALCOHOL, SALT, AND OPIUM DID THE TRICK.
OPIUM HAS BEEN ESPECIALLY LUCRATIVE WITH REVENUES INCREASING 50% AND GENERATING A THIRD OF THE COLONY'S INCOME.
UNDER MY LEADERSHIP WE PIONEERED A FASTER BURNING FORMULA; EXPANDED STATE CONTROLLED PROCESSING AND DISTRIBUTION CENTERS; AND FOUND CHEAPER SUPPLIERS.
THE FAST BURNING MIXTURE MEANT ADDICTS SMOKED MORE THAN THEY HAD BEFORE.
THE INCREASING NUMBER OF OPIUM DENS SPEAKS TO HIS SUCCESS... AS DOES THE NUMBER OF ADDICTS.
PREVIOUSLY, WE BOUGHT INDIAN OPIUM AND PROCESSED IT IN SAIGON. I FOUND CHEAPER SUPPLIERS IN YUNNAN, OUR NEW SPHERE OF INFLUENCE IN CHINA, AND SHIPPED IT DOWN THE RED RIVER TO HANOI.
Shanghai
CHINE
YUNNAN
INDE
Hanoi
REGIONAL DISTRIBUTORS DELIVERED THE DRUG TO OPIUM DENS AND RETAIL CENTERS THROUGHOUT THE COLONIES AND FRENCH MERCHANTS SENT IT TO THE FRENCH CONCESSION IN SHANGHAI.
WE CAN USE THESE PROFITS FOR A VARIETY OF PUBLIC WORKS PROJECTS: ROADS, BRIDGES, HANOI'S GREAT BUILDINGS, AND A FEW SCHOOLS!
CHINE
Kunming
Hanoi
Hai Phong
WE WILL ALSO USE THIS MONEY TO BUILD THE HANOI TO KUNMING RAILWAY, WHICH WILL ALLOW US TO BRING MORE OPIUM INTO INDOCHINE.

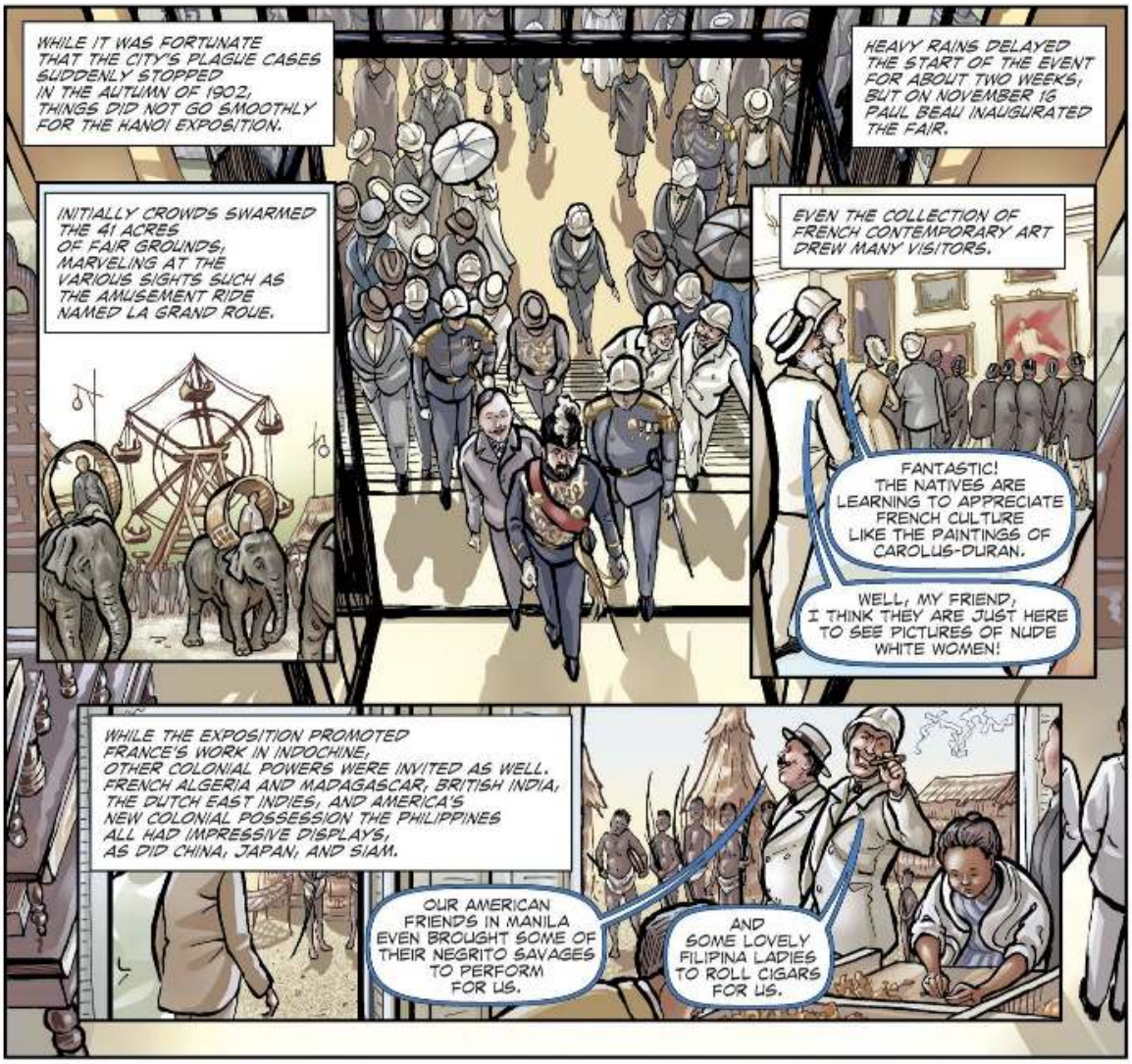

AS SOON AS HE STARTED WORK ON MODERNIZING HANOI, PAUL DOUMER BEGAN PLANNING A MASSIVE COMING OUT PARTY FOR HIS NEW CITY. IN 1898, AFTER SECURING A LOAN OF SOME 280,000,000 FRANCS, HE ANNOUNCED:
IN DECEMBER 1901, HANOI WILL HOST AN INTERNATIONAL EXPOSITION. WE WILL INVITE THE WORLD TO SEE WHAT WE HAVE DONE HERE.
WE WILL SHOW OTHER COLONIAL POWERS HOW FRENCH ENGINEERING TRANSFORMED HANOI. FRENCH BUSINESSES WILL DISPLAY THEIR PRODUCTS. WE WILL HIGHLIGHT TONKIN AS THE GATEWAY TO THE RICHES OF YUNNAN. AND OUR VIETNAMESE SUBJECTS WILL MARVEL AT FRANCE'S INDUSTRIAL MIGHT!
I ALSO NEED TO JUSTIFY SPENDING SO MUCH MONEY ON THIS COLONY BEFORE I RETURN TO PARIS FOR GOOD.
BUT THE IDEA WAS WITH NOT WITHOUT CRITICS AND THE PROJECT FACED A FEW SETBACKS.
HANOI IS TOO FAR AWAY FROM THE MAIN PASSENGER SHIPPING ROUTES.
THEY CAN LAND AT HAIPHONG, IT'S NOT TOO FAR FROM THE BUSY SINGAPORE-HONG KONG LINE.
BUT HOW WILL THEY GET FROM HAIPHONG TO HANOI?
DOUMER IS BUILDING A RAILWAY AND A BRIDGE OVER THE RED RIVER.
LET'S HOPE THEY ARE DONE IN TIME!
FOLLOWING EARLIER PRACTICES OF COLONIAL EMINENT DOMAIN, DOUMER CONFISCATED LAND DIRECTLY IN FRONT OF WHAT WOULD BE THE NEW TRAIN STATION.
DID YOU HEAR? DOUMER THE DICTATOR IS SEIZING OUR RACETRACK FOR HIS EXPOSITION HALL.
UGH...WHAT WILL WE DO TO AMUSE OURSELVES? FISH IN THIS SWAMP LIKE THE NATIVES?
HA, HA! AFRAID NOT. HE IS SEIZING THAT LAND, TOO.
THE FRENCH SAY WE HAVE TO LEAVE OUR SHRIMP PONDS AND RICE PADDIES.
THEY TAKE, TAKE, TAKE... WHEN WILL THEY STOP?
HOW WILL WE FEED OURSELVES?


IN APRIL, 1902, THE COLONIAL AUTHORITIES SWUNG INTO ACTION... EVEN THOUGH SOME CONFUSION REMAINED ABOUT THE NATURE OF THE DISEASE.
GENTLEMEN, WE MUST MOBILIZE ALL OF OUR RESOURCES TO PROTECT HANOI. OUR BORDER DEFENSES HAVE FAILED AND THE PLAGUE HAS ENTERED TONKIN FROM CHINA BY TWO DIRECTIONS, OVERSEAS AND OVERLAND.
NOW THAT IT'S HERE IN HANOI WE MUST FIGHT TO SAVE OUR CITY FROM AN ALL-OUT EPIDEMIC.
HOW? WE DON'T EVEN KNOW HOW IT SPREADS. BUT THE CHINESE ARE SOMEHOW TO BLAME.
I HEAR IT'S DIRT. IT LIVES IN THE DIRT.
DIRT? THEN THAT'S WHY THE FILTHY CHINESE COOLIES HAVE IT.
WITH HIS PATRON PAUL DOUMER GONE, YERSIN WAS REGULARLY FRUSTRATED WITH THE NEW ADMINISTRATORS IN HANOI.
OUR LATEST RESEARCH POINTS TO RATS AS THE VECTOR SPREADING THE DISEASE.
ARE THE RATS BITING US?
RAT BITES?!?! REVOLTING.
NO, NO. I EXPLAINED ALL OF THIS TO DOUMER MONTHS AGO!
IT'S THE RAT FLEAS. THEY SPREAD THE DISEASE. WE CAN'T GET RID OF THE FLEAS, SO WE ARE GOING TO ELIMINATE THEIR HOSTS. REMOVING THE RATS WILL STOP THE DISEASE AND PROTECT THE PEOPLE OF HANOI.
THIS WILL DEMONSTRATE FRANCE'S CIVILIZING MISSION IN ACTION!
THERE ARE NO PROBLEMS MODERN SCIENCE CAN'T OVERCOME. PAUL BERT WOULD BE PROUD OF US!
BUT EXACTLY WHO IS GOING TO CATCH THESE DAMN RATS?
DR. SÉREZ WANTS HANOI'S MUNICIPAL GOVERNMENT TO SEND ITS WORKERS INTO THE CITY'S SEWER SYSTEM.


Friday
April
25
INITIALLY, THE HUNT GOT OFF TO A SLOW START.
HOW WAS THE FIRST DAY OF THE HUNT?
THE NATIVES BROUGHT IN 95 RATS FROM THE FIRST ARRONDISEMENT* AND 72 FROM THE SECOND ARRONDISEMENT.
THAT'S NOT MUCH.
REGARDLESS, I STILL HAVE TO MARK EACH RAT AND PAY THE 4 CENTS TO THE ANNAMITES.
*AN URBAN DISTRICT. PARIS FAMOUSLY HAS 20 ARRONDISEMENTS.
Saturday
April
26
IN THE NEXT DAYS THE NUMBERS STEADILY INCREASED.
619 FOR THE WHOLE CITY.
BETTER, BUT STILL JUST A TINY PORTION OF HANOI'S RODENT RESIDENTS.
Sunday
April
27
THE COLONIAL BUREAUCRACY SYSTEMATICALLY RECORDED EACH DEAD RAT BROUGHT IN AND EVERY CENT PAID OUT.
OVER A THOUSAND TODAY!
Monday
April
28
1360
Tuesday
April
29
1182
WELL, MY FRIENDS, WE HAVE KILLED ALMOST 8,000 RATS...
7,985 TO BE PRECISE!
...IN JUST THE FIRST WEEK. THIS CRAZY SCHEME MIGHT WORK AFTER ALL. HANOI WILL BE READY TO HOST THE EXPOSITION.
Jeudi
Mai
1
Wednesday
April
30
1386
Thursday
May
1
2175

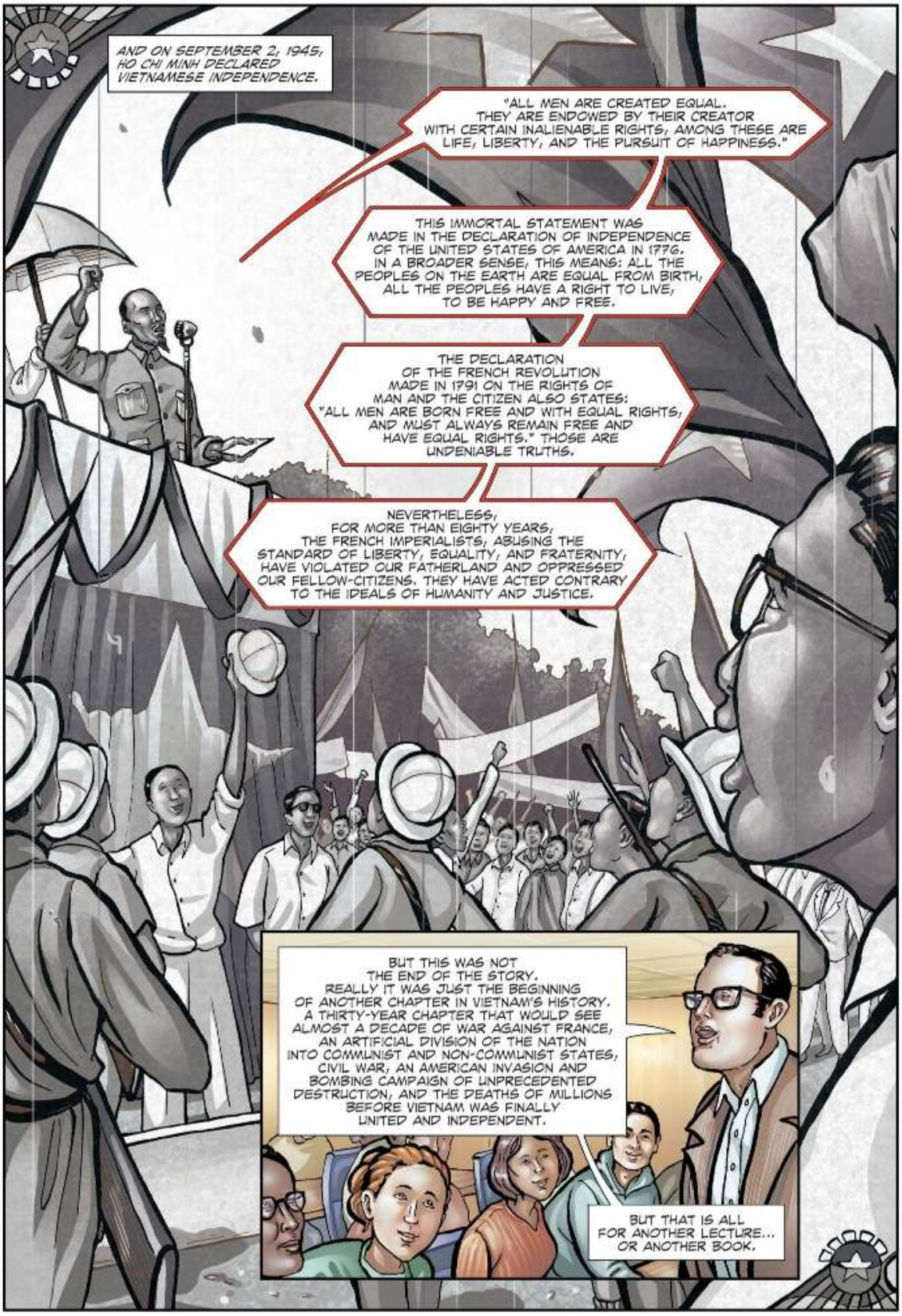

AS THE RAT HUNT CONTINUED INTO JUNE OF 1902, THE DAILY COUNT CONTINUED TO STUN THE FRENCH AUTHORITIES.
THE NUMBERS ARE UNBELIEVABLE.
YES, I'M NOT SURE IF I DO BELIEVE THEM.
Monday June 2 13605
Wednesday June 4 13660
SOME OF THESE TAILS ARE NOT FROM RATS!
HOW AM I SUPPOSED TO KNOW THAT? I'M NOT A ZOOLOGIST.
YOU DON'T NEED A DEGREE IN NATURAL PHILOSOPHY TO DO THIS JOB. RATS HAVE MUCH BIGGER TAILS. ANY FOOL KNOWS THIS! LOOK HOW SMALL THESE TAILS ARE, YOU IDIOT. THIS IS FROM A MOUSE OR MAYBE A VOLE.
A VOLE? WHAT'S A VOLE?
IT'S A LITTLE FURRY THING THAT'S BIGGER THAN A MOUSE BUT... UMMM...NEVER MIND!...IT'S SMALLER THAN A SEWER RAT! JUST DON'T PAY THE NATIVES FOR SMALL TAILS!
June 1 12378
THE FRENCH SAY THESE TAILS ARE NO GOOD. THEY WON'T PAY FOR SMALL TAILS.
HMMM, MAYBE THEY KNOW THESE ARE FROM THE VILLAGES. RICE FIELD RATS ARE SMALLER, OF COURSE.
OH, YEAH, OF COURSE. RATS HAVE MUCH BIGGER TAILS. ANY FOOL KNOWS THIS!
Thursday June 12 20114
OVER 20 THOUSAND RATS IN A SINGLE DAY! WHAT A SUCCESS. WE WILL ELIMINATE THE PLAGUE AS A THREAT TO HANOI AND TO THE EXPOSITION.
COMMISSARIAT DE POLICE 1ER ARRONDISSEMENT
BUT AT WHAT COST? WE CAN'T KEEP DISHING OUT HANDFULS OF CASH TO THESE ANNAMITES, AND THOSE TAILS ARE STILL LOOKING SUSPECT.
Friday June 13 15659
THE FRENCH HAVE REDUCED THE PRICE AGAIN. NOW IT IS ONLY HALF A CENT PER TAIL.
DON'T WORRY, WE HAVE A NEW SHIPMENT FROM THE VILLAGES COMING IN THIS AFTERNOON.
Saturday June 14 15425
WE NEED MORE DETAILED INFORMATION. IN ADDITION TO THE TOTAL KILLED, RECORD THE NUMBER OF ADULTS AND BABIES. THE MORE DATA WE CAN COLLECT, THE BETTER WE CAN CONTROL THE SITUATION.
Friday June 20 10185 adult 4599 petit 14784
Tuesday June 24 8829 adult 1435 petit 10264
Thursday July 3 13928 adult 2754 petit 16708*
Friday July 4 17070 adult 2727 petit 19827
*ON SOME OF THESE FORMS THE NUMBERS DON'T ADD UP, THROWING THESE STATISTICS UNDER A CERTAIN DEGREE OF SUSPICION. THIS WAS NOT AN UNCOMMON PHENOMENON IN THE COLONIAL BUREAUCRACIES.


BY EARLY JULY FRUSTRATIONS WITH THE RAT HUNT LED TO OPEN FEUDING AMONGST EXASPERATED FRENCH HEALTH OFFICIALS AND HIGH-LEVEL ADMINISTRATORS INCLUDING THE SUPERIOR RESIDENT OF TONKIN.
MY DEAR DR. SÉREZ, THIS HUNT IS NOT WORKING. THESE DAMN NATIVES ARE BRINGING IN RATS FROM THE PROVINCES OR RAISING LITTERS HERE IN THE CITY!
PERHAPS... RESIDENT FOURÈS, PERHAPS THAT DOES HAPPEN BUT WE CAN DO THIS. WE CAN ELIMINATE THE RATS. JUST INCREASE THE BOUNTY AND GIVE THE ANNAMITE HUNTERS OPEN ACCESS TO THE SEWERS. THEY WILL CLEAN THEM OUT IN NO TIME.
IMPOSSIBLE! THAT WILL JUST FURTHER SPREAD DISEASE AROUND THE CITY.
TO CALM THE VARIOUS FACTIONS, THE NEW GOVERNOR GENERAL CONTINUED THE BOUNTY PROGRAM BUT LOWERED THE PAYMENT TO 1 CENT FOR EVERY 5 RAT-TAILS.
Sunday July 6
10 486 adulte
3340 petit
14 197
Monday July 7
12 694 adulte
1 900 petit
14 594
Tuesday July 8
13 785 adulte
2640 petit
16 425
Wednesday July 9
40
Thursday July 10
0
AFTER 644,922 RECORDED DEATHS, HANOI'S GREAT RAT HUNT CAME TO A SUDDEN HALT.
THAT PRICE IS TOO LOW. IT'S JUST NOT WORTH THE WORK.
DON'T WORRY, WE WILL FIGURE OUT SOMETHING ELSE. FOR NOW, JUST LET THE RATS GO FREE.
AS THE FIRST ROUND OF THE GREAT RAT HUNT ENDED, WE MIGHT IMAGINE THAT HANOI'S RATS BREATHED A SIGH OF RELIEF.
GIVEN WHAT WE KNOW ABOUT RODENT REPRODUCTION RATES, THE POPULATION LIKELY REBOUNDED WITHIN A FEW MONTHS.


WHILE IT WAS FORTUNATE THAT THE CITY'S PLAGUE CASES SUDDENLY STOPPED IN THE AUTUMN OF 1902, THINGS DID NOT GO SMOOTHLY FOR THE HANOI EXPOSITION.
HEAVY RAINS DELAYED THE START OF THE EVENT FOR ABOUT TWO WEEKS, BUT ON NOVEMBER 16 PAUL BEAU INAUGURATED THE FAIR.
INITIALLY CROWDS SWARMED THE 41 ACRES OF FAIR GROUNDS, MARVELING AT THE VARIOUS SIGHTS SUCH AS THE AMUSEMENT RIDE NAMED LA GRAND ROUE.
EVEN THE COLLECTION OF FRENCH CONTEMPORARY ART DREW MANY VISITORS.
FANTASTIC! THE NATIVES ARE LEARNING TO APPRECIATE FRENCH CULTURE LIKE THE PAINTINGS OF CAROLUS-DURAN.
WELL, MY FRIEND, I THINK THEY ARE JUST HERE TO SEE PICTURES OF NUDE WHITE WOMEN!
WHILE THE EXPOSITION PROMOTED FRANCE'S WORK IN INDOCHINE, OTHER COLONIAL POWERS WERE INVITED AS WELL. FRENCH ALGERIA AND MADAGASCAR, BRITISH INDIA, THE DUTCH EAST INDIES, AND AMERICA'S NEW COLONIAL POSSESSION THE PHILIPPINES ALL HAD IMPRESSIVE DISPLAYS, AS DID CHINA, JAPAN, AND SIAM.
OUR AMERICAN FRIENDS IN MANILA EVEN BROUGHT SOME OF THEIR NEGRITO SAVAGES TO PERFORM FOR US.
AND SOME LOVELY FILIPINA LADIES TO ROLL CIGARS FOR US.


HOWEVER, AFTER A FEW WEEKS THE CROWDS BEGAN TO THIN AND FRENCH OFFICIALS HAD TO ORGANIZE TOURS TO GET THEIR VIETNAMESE SUBJECTS TO THE FAIR. IT WAS SOON CLEAR THAT THE EXPOSITION WAS GOING TO PLUNGE THE CITY INTO DEBT.
ONE GROUP OF UNWELCOME VISITORS NEEDED NO INVITATION. TO THE CHAGRIN OF THE FRENCH AUTHORITIES, SEVERAL OF THE BUILDINGS WERE INFESTED WITH RATS.


VIETNAMESE YOUTH IN HANOI SEIZED THE OPPORTUNITY AND ATTACKED SYMBOLS OF THE FRENCH EMPIRE.
WHEN HANOI'S NEW VIETNAMESE MAYOR ORDERED THE CITY'S FRENCH STATUES DESTROYED, DOWN CAME JEAN DUPUIS...
HE WAS A GUN RUNNER AND A SMUGGLER!
...DOWN CAME WORLD WAR ONE VETERANS...
LEAVE THE FARMER. HE'S ONE OF US!
...DOWN CAME LIBERTY (KNOWN TO THE LOCALS AS THE LADY WITH THE OPEN SKIRT)...
LOOK AT HER SPREAD LEGS. TYPICAL FRENCH WOMAN WITH NO SHAME!
...AND DOWN CAME PAUL BERT...
PAUL BERT STANDS TALL-- A STATUE IN THE PARK. LOOK AT HIS MUG: IT MAKES YOU SICK, HIS SMIRK.
FREEDOM? EQUALITY? A GANG OF ROGUES. FRATERNITY? THE BROTHERHOOD OF THIEVES.
THEY'VE SUCKED OUT BLOOD-- AN OPEN SECRET NOW. THEY'VE ROBBED AND MURDERED--NO MORE COVER UP.
THESE DAYS COLONISTS ARE DOOMED TO GO-- HOW COULD THEY DODGE AND MISS OUR HAMMERS' BLOWS?*
*"WRECKING THE STATUE OF PAUL BERT," THIEN THE, 1945.
FRENCH HANOI SEEMED TO BE DYING.


AND ON SEPTEMBER 2, 1945, HO CHI MINH DECLARED VIETNAMESE INDEPENDENCE.
"ALL MEN ARE CREATED EQUAL. THEY ARE ENDOWED BY THEIR CREATOR WITH CERTAIN INALIENABLE RIGHTS, AMONG THESE ARE LIFE, LIBERTY, AND THE PURSUIT OF HAPPINESS."
THIS IMMORTAL STATEMENT WAS MADE IN THE DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA IN 1776. IN A BROADER SENSE, THIS MEANS: ALL THE PEOPLES ON THE EARTH ARE EQUAL FROM BIRTH, ALL THE PEOPLES HAVE A RIGHT TO LIVE, TO BE HAPPY AND FREE.
THE DECLARATION OF THE FRENCH REVOLUTION MADE IN 1791 ON THE RIGHTS OF MAN AND THE CITIZEN ALSO STATES: "ALL MEN ARE BORN FREE AND WITH EQUAL RIGHTS, AND MUST ALWAYS REMAIN FREE AND HAVE EQUAL RIGHTS." THOSE ARE UNDENIABLE TRUTHS.
NEVERTHELESS, FOR MORE THAN EIGHTY YEARS, THE FRENCH IMPERIALISTS, ABUSING THE STANDARD OF LIBERTY, EQUALITY, AND FRATERNITY, HAVE VIOLATED OUR FATHERLAND AND OPPRESSED OUR FELLOW-CITIZENS. THEY HAVE ACTED CONTRARY TO THE IDEALS OF HUMANITY AND JUSTICE.
BUT THIS WAS NOT THE END OF THE STORY. REALLY IT WAS JUST THE BEGINNING OF ANOTHER CHAPTER IN VIETNAM'S HISTORY. A THIRTY-YEAR CHAPTER THAT WOULD SEE ALMOST A DECADE OF WAR AGAINST FRANCE, AN ARTIFICIAL DIVISION OF THE NATION INTO COMMUNIST AND NON-COMMUNIST STATES, CIVIL WAR, AN AMERICAN INVASION AND BOMBING CAMPAIGN OF UNPRECEDENTED DESTRUCTION, AND THE DEATHS OF MILLIONS BEFORE VIETNAM WAS FINALLY UNITED AND INDEPENDENT.
BUT THAT IS ALL FOR ANOTHER LECTURE... OR ANOTHER BOOK.